

the 2008 recession, advocated that cash-strapped families consider dumping their cars to save money.

If you have to commute to campus, buy an electric bike instead of a car. I love them. They're rapidly growing in popularity in car-congested cities in China, and I expect they'll be a massive trend in North America as well. Unlike Vespas or scooters, which are mingled in with the rest of the traffic, you can stay in a safer bike lane and still park for free with a good lock. You can travel more than sixty miles with one overnight charge of a high-powered lithium battery at a cost of about 25 cents. And if it runs out of power, most e-bikes switch back to a regular bike automatically. They're pricey—anywhere from \$1,500 to \$4,000—but that's probably your used-car budget. Unlike a car, the bike will hold its value and pay for itself in a year. You'll stay fit and save a fortune.



Driving my mother's car near our home in Switzerland in 1970. She taught me that you don't want to own one until you are employed.

(Georgette Kanawaty)